

You don't need a scheduling certification to catch a bad baseline before you sign off on it. A bad baseline doesn't look bad — it has thousands of activities, clean Gantt bars, and a finish date that matches what you were told. Check these **5 things** first. Print this, take it into the review.

☐ **1 Negative float that's already baked in**

Look for: Any activity showing negative total float on day one of the baseline.

Why it matters: Negative float on a freshly submitted schedule means it's already behind before a shovel hits the ground — either an unrealistic plan, or a hard date fighting the logic underneath it.

NOTES

☐ **2 Hard constraints doing the logic's job**

Look for: A stack of "Must Finish On" or "Start On" constraints pinning dates instead of activity relationships.

Why it matters: A few constraints are normal. Dozens usually means the schedule can't support its own dates on logic alone, so someone nailed them in place to hit the number the contract needed.

NOTES

☐ **3 Open ends and dangling activities**

Look for: Activities with no predecessor, no successor, or both — not tied into the rest of the network.

Why it matters: A delay to a dangling activity never ripples through to the finish date. Large parts of the schedule can look "on track" simply because they aren't connected to anything.

NOTES

☐ **4 Activities that run for months**

Look for: Any single activity with a duration over roughly 44 working days and no interim milestones inside it.

Why it matters: A long, unbroken activity is a black box — it can report "in progress" for months without ever being provably behind. That's where slippage hides.

NOTES

☐ **5 A critical path that doesn't make sense**

Look for: Trace the critical (longest) path end to end — does it run through structure and MEP, or through landscaping and signage?

Why it matters: The critical path determines your finish date. If the chain protecting that date doesn't match how the job actually gets built, the date it's protecting is fiction.

NOTES

Ran out of time to check all five by hand? **Ordo7** runs these checks automatically from a plain-language upload — no Primavera expertise required.

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